

Credit itself is not the enemy. We are going to talk about good credit versus bad credit shortly, and how we can use good credit to achieve amazing wealth. Credit is not the evil that needs to be rallied against. The tactics of the entire consumer lending industry are the wicked devices that need improving.

Because credit card debt is at an all-time high, and the fees and penalties and interest rates are at all-time highs, credit card delinquencies are in full bloom. The collection agencies are tickled. Business is booming for them. Debt is big business, and the creditors and collectors are the sharks who are circling, because they smell blood.

Know Your Rights

The debt collectors do have rules that they are supposed to adhere to, but that does not mean that they will. However, if you know your rights, you can understand that the fire-breathing dragon really is nothing but hot air.

Under a law that was passed called the Fair Debt Collection Practices Act, debt collectors MAY NOT:

- ✓ Contact you earlier than 8 a.m. or later than 8 p.m.
- ✓ Contact you by phone after you have requested in writing that they stop.
- ✓ Contact you at work despite their knowledge of your employer's disapproval.
- ✓ Tell people, like your boss or family members, that you owe money.
- ✓ Tell you that they will take your wages.
- ✓ Tell you that they can have you arrested.
- ✓ Tell you that they will sue you. (Only your creditors can sue you.)
- ✓ Send you papers that look like court papers.
- ✓ Talk to anyone but you. (They are not supposed to talk to your kids.)

This act came about because Congressional findings in 1977 stated there was “abundant evidence of the use of abusive, deceptive, and unfair debt collection practices by many debt collectors. Abusive debt collection